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Title: Paira Mall — Wellcome Collection catalogue (WA/HMM/CM/Pai)

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Catalogue description

Paira Mall was employed as a collecting agent for the Wellcome Historical Medical Museum (WHMM). Between 1911 and 1921 he travelled widely on behalf of the Museum in India and the Far East, gathering an extensive collection of oriental manuscripts and objects.

These diaries, ledgers and notebooks relate to his collecting trips and subsequent cataloguing of materials. See also WA/HMM/Ear/5 for Mall's correspondence with and reports to C.J.S. Thompson, 1910–1924.

Collection structure

Reference: WA/HMM/CM/Pai · Part of: Wellcome Historical Medical Museum and Library · Physical description: 3 boxes · Sub-series: Diaries (Pai/A), Accounts (Pai/B), Notebooks (Pai/C).

Date: Early 20th century. Acquisition note: WHMM. Location: Wellcome Collection, 183 Euston Road, London.

Research note (Infinity Foundation)

Paira Mall's papers are a primary trail for how South Asian medical manuscripts and materia medica entered European institutional collections in the early twentieth century—useful context for colonial knowledge-transfer work alongside earlier Dutch-era sources such as Hortus Malabaricus.

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